

CMS Studio & Publisher Comprehensive Guide

Complete reference manual describing how each CMS publishing option functions behind the scenes and exactly where that content displays across the public Old Mango Tree website.

Author / Editorial: Old Mango Tree Technology Team | **Target Version:** Production v0.2.0 | **Database Engine:** Supabase Headless CMS

Core Publishing Philosophy: Old Mango Tree runs on a decoupled, high-speed static architecture powered by Next.js and Supabase. Editors produce content inside the dedicated **Article Studio** (/publisher). When an action is taken (Draft, Schedule, or Publish), the system instantly writes structured metadata, HTML bodies, and media paths to Supabase. Readers across the world receive static, ultra-fast pages augmented with live Realtime listeners. This manual details every single control, button, switch, and field available to editors.

1. Publishing Actions & Toolbar Controls

The top sticky toolbar contains the primary lifecycle triggers for any piece of journalism.

Toolbar Option	How It Works (Functionality)	Where Content Displays (Public & CMS Visibility)
Save Draft (Private Cloud Save)	Saves the story to Supabase with status: 'draft'. In addition, the editor automatically caches work in browser localStorage every 15 seconds to prevent data loss. Drafts do not require mandatory fields like categories or authors.	Public Site: <u>NOWHERE</u> . Completely invisible to readers, search engines, and feeds. CMS: Accessible only inside the Drafts & Published Stories Library under the Drafts tab.
Schedule Release (Time-Locked Automated Publish)	Opens date & time calendar picker. Sets status: 'scheduled' and stores the exact future UTC timestamp in published_at. The Supabase query filters out items until published_at <= now(). Once reached, the database auto-promotes status to published.	Public Site: Hidden until target timestamp arrives. The exact second it matures, it automatically surfaces on Homepage, Category feed, and /articles/[slug]. CMS: Visible under Scheduled tab with live countdown.
Publish Live (Instant Public Release)	Instantly sets status: 'published', writes current timestamp, invalidates client memory cache, and broadcasts a Postgres realtime event across all active visitors.	Public Site: Immediately live on: • Homepage Lead/Grid (/) • Latest Stories Feed (/latest) • Assigned Category (/category) • Canonical Article URL (/articles/[slug]) • RSS Feeds & Search Index (/search).
Drafts & Articles Library (Folder Icon)	Opens the centralized story manager modal with three filter tabs: Drafts , Scheduled , and Published . Includes search bar, 'Load to Editor', 'Publish Now', and 'Delete'.	CMS Only: Modal overlay. Allows resuming any draft or promoting any scheduled piece to live immediately without waiting for the timer.
Live Preview (Eye Icon)	Renders a responsive preview overlay simulating exact desktop and mobile viewports with reader typography, dark/light contrast, audio player header, and author cards.	CMS Only: Modal preview for author verification before publishing live.
HTML Source Toggle (Code Icon)	Switches between visual TipTap WYSIWYG editor and raw HTML source code. Enables inserting custom embeds (YouTube iframes, blockquotes, audio embeds, custom CSS classes).	Public Site: Whatever HTML is structured here renders directly inside the article body container at /articles/[slug].
New Blank Article (Plus Icon)	Clears the editor workspace, unlinks current draft slug, clears local cache, and prepares a pristine canvas for a new story.	CMS Only: Workspace reset tool.

2. Publishing Modes: Written Stories vs Podcasts

The top segmented pill allows toggling between Written Journalism and Spoken Audio journalism.

Publishing Mode	How It Works (Functionality)	Where Content Displays (Public Website Visibility)
Standard Story / Column	Tailored for traditional text journalism, op-eds, cultural essays, film reviews, and investigative columns. Focuses on typography, headings, pull quotes, and visual imagery.	- Homepage Top Stories & Category Grid (/) - Latest Feed (/latest) - Respective Department page (e.g. /cinema, /politics) - Full reading experience at /articles/[slug].
Audio Story / Podcast Episode	Activates podcast metadata fields. Automatically assigns category to podcast and tags with Audio & Podcast, Podcast, and Audio Story. Enables Speaker name, Audio file URL/Upload, and Duration.	- Dedicated Podcasts Hub (/podcasts) - Triggers the Global Sticky Audio Player bottom bar across the entire site with playback speeds (.5x to 2x), mute, scrub bar. - Header Audio Player banner directly at top of /articles/[slug]. - Audio wave pill badge on story cards.

3. Editorial Metadata, Slug Routing & Department Taxonomy

These fields establish the structural identity, search engine discoverability, and navigation of every story.

Metadata Field	How It Works (Functionality)	Where Content Displays (Public Website Visibility)
Story Headline (Title)	The primary editorial title. Auto-generates initial URL slug if not customized. Renders in serif or sans based on typography rules.	- Main headline on /articles/[slug] - Title on card widgets across homepage and categories - Browser tab title (<title> tag) - Social share card preview title.
Short Teaser (Excerpt)	1 to 2 sentence editorial synopsis. Summarizes the thesis or hook of the piece.	- Subtitle teaser text on homepage card feeds - Standfirst italicized summary below title on article page - Google Search snippet (meta description) - WhatsApp / Twitter / LinkedIn preview description.
Article Web Address (Slug)	The URL-safe string identifier (e.g. kerala-monsoon-travelogue). Cleaned automatically to lowercase alphanumeric characters with hyphens.	Forms the permanent canonical URL: https://oldmangotree.com/articles/[slug] Also mapped to historical category path /[category]/[slug].
Category Selector	Editorial departmental taxonomy assigning the story to its specific section.	Maps directly to top-level public category feeds: Politics → /politics Cinema → /cinema Sports → /sports Literature → /literature The Shade → /the-shade (Arts & Culture) Fallen Mangoes → /fallen-mangoes (Columns/Satire) Webzine → /magazine Special Series → /series
Author / Columnist Selector	Assigns author attribution. Can select established staff writers or type custom guest columnist name.	- Byline below headline on article page - Author card & bio box at footer of story - Author filter archive across website.
Tags & Keywords	Multi-tag classification system. Supports standard topic pills plus custom tag addition via input box.	- Interactive tag pills at bottom of article - Tag archive pages at /tag/[tag] - Cross-linking related stories in search (/search).

4. Cover Imagery, Visuals & Audio Narration

Configuration options for rich multimedia storytelling.

Media Asset Field	How It Works (Functionality)	Where Content Displays (Public Website Visibility)
Cover Image URL / Upload	Accepts direct image link (Unsplash, external CDN) or direct upload to Supabase Storage bucket with live thumbnail preview.	- Hero image banner at top of article page (/articles/[slug]) - Thumbnail visual on all feed cards and homepage grids - OpenGraph image for social previews (WhatsApp/Twitter/FB).
Audio Narration File URL / Upload	Accepts MP3/M4A URL or file upload to Supabase. Embeds audio playback into written stories or podcast episodes.	- Streams via Global Sticky Audio Player bottom bar - Renders 'Listen to Audio Narration' header on article page - Powers audio cards on /podcasts.
Speaker / Narrator Name & Duration	Specifies who narrated the piece (e.g. Akhil U Krishnan) and audio run length.	- Audio player title & speaker credit line - Duration badge (e.g. '18 mins') on podcast cards.

5. Story Layout Flags & Editorial Spotlight Switches

Four editorial flags dictate card sizing, visual emphasis, and homepage positioning.

Editorial Switch	How It Works (Functionality)	Where Content Displays (Public Website Visibility)
Lead Story (Front Page Hero) (is_lead_story)	Flags story as the primary editorial masterpiece of the day.	Homepage Primary Slot: Takes the top-left jumbo spotlight position on https://oldmangotree.com/ with full-width hero card, larger font, and highest visual hierarchy.
Cover Feature (is_cover)	Designates story as a magazine-style cover piece.	Highlighted with special gold/brand border, prominent badge, and priority top carousel positioning.
Longform / Deep Dive (is_longform)	Indicates exhaustive investigative or analytical essays (3,000+ words).	Displays 'Deep Dive' badge, enhanced serif typography layout, and calculated reading time badge (e.g. '14 min read').
Premium / Exclusive (is_premium)	Labels the story as an exclusive editorial creation.	Displays 'Exclusive / Premium' badge across all card grids and header on /articles/[slug].

6. Curated Collections: Webzine Issues & Special Series

Grouping mechanisms for episodic journalism and periodical digital magazines.

Collection Mechanism	How It Works (Functionality)	Where Content Displays (Public Website Visibility)
Webzine Issue Packet (e.g. 'Packet 1')	Bundles articles into curated periodic digital magazine issues. Enables thematic reading of essays, poetry, and art.	- Digital Magazine Kiosk (/magazine) - Dedicated Issue landing page (/magazine/packet-1) 'Webzine Issue' badge on article cards.
Special Series & Episode Number (e.g. Title: 'The Hill Diaries', Ep: 2)	Creates serialized narrative columns. Groups multiple articles under a parent series slug with strict chronological episode ordering.	- Series Index (/series) - Dedicated Series Dossier page (/series/[slug]) with episode list and descriptions - Sequential Next/Previous Episode navigation buttons on article pages.

7. Master Website Display Directory (Route-by-Route Reference)

Quick reference mapping every public URL on Old Mango Tree to the exact options that populate it.

Public URL / Route	What Content Displays Here?	Required CMS Option Settings
/ (Homepage)	Top Lead Story Hero, Highlight Cards (positions 2-4), chronological grid, category tabs.	Any story with status: 'published'. • Set Lead Story to take top hero slot.
/latest (Latest Feed)	Pure chronological stream of all recent journalism, columns, and podcasts.	Any story with status: 'published', sorted latest first.
/articles/[slug] (Article View)	Full-screen immersive reading view with cover image, byline, audio player bar, content, tags, and comments.	The exact slug configured in the CMS studio. Live when published or scheduled release time arrives.
/[category] (Category Feeds)	Dedicated feeds for Politics, Cinema, Sports, Literature, The Shade, Fallen Mangoes, Economy, Science, Opinion.	Set Category dropdown to the corresponding department.
/podcasts (Podcasts Hub)	Dedicated directory of audio stories, interviews, and podcast episodes with one-click streaming.	Set mode to Audio Story / Podcast OR attach Audio Narration URL.
/magazine (Webzine Hub)	Digital magazine showcase organized by issue packets.	Set Category to Webzine OR assign Webzine Issue Packet (e.g. Packet 1).
/series (Special Series)	Dossiers of investigative serialized reporting columns.	Assign a Series Title and Episode Number .
/tag/[tag] (Topic Archive)	Archive of stories sharing a specific tag or keyword.	Select or type the tag in the Tags & Keywords section.
/search (Live Search)	Instant search results matching titles, excerpts, authors, and body text.	All live published content is automatically indexed.

8. Automated Scheduling Engine & Editorial Workflow

How Automated Publishing Works at Release Time:

- Selecting the Time:** When scheduling a piece, choose your target release time in the modal. The system converts your local selection into a standard UTC timestamp saved in Supabase.
- Time-Lock Security:** The public website queries Supabase with `published_at <= now()`. Any scheduled article remains 100% inaccessible to readers before the clock hits that exact minute.
- Zero-Touch Auto-Release:** The instant the scheduled timestamp arrives, the database query automatically matches the story. The system auto-promotes the database record status to 'published'.
- Realtime Visitor Heartbeat:** An active 30-second heartbeat and Supabase Realtime channel ensures that active readers on the website will see the newly published story appear without needing to refresh their browser.
- Library Synchronization:** Inside the **Drafts & Published Stories Library**, the story automatically moves from the **Scheduled** tab into the **Published** tab with its live publication date.